

INFANTRY UNIFORMS AND EQUIPMENT

The latter part of the 20th century saw the widespread introduction of body armour as part of the basic infantry kit in the armies of all developed countries. New synthetic materials, such as Kevlar and Spectra, were used to make vests that could protect against small-arms fire; plates made from ceramic or composite materials could be fitted into special pockets in the vests to protect vulnerable areas of the body against high-velocity rounds. Cutting-edge technology also shaped the development of uniforms, which incorporated flame-retardant and even anti-malarial elements.



▲ **ADVANCED BOMB SUIT**
Date 1990s
Origin UK
Material Nomex, Kevlar, foam, armoured plates

Bomb suits are constructed from many layers of armoured material, since they are meant to protect against both explosive fragments and a bomb's blast wave. To minimize body heat, they are also fitted with their own cooling system.

► MK 6 HELMET

Date 1986
Origin UK
Material Ballistic nylon

This helmet was developed for the British Army to improve protection and to be worn in a variety of environments, including inside armoured vehicles.



► DESERT CAMOUFLAGE UNIFORM

Date 1990
Origin UK
Material Cotton, nylon

Designed for the conditions encountered in Iraq and Afghanistan, this two-colour Disruptive Pattern Material (DPM) desert uniform combines effective camouflage with a material adapted for use in high temperatures.



▼ 6B5 BODY ARMOUR

Date 1986
Origin Soviet Union
Material Nylon, Kevlar, titanium/ceramic plates

Used extensively during the conflict in Chechnya in the 1990s, 6B5 body armour was made of Kevlar sheets, with inserts of either ceramic or titanium to provide extra ballistic protection.



Integral magazine pouch

Anti-splinter collar

▼ DESERT BOOTS

Date 1990s
Origin UK
Material Suede, Cordura, rubber

Lightweight patrol boots were designed for use in warm weather. They have been used extensively by British troops operating in Iraq and Afghanistan.



Rubber sole

